PROGRESS REPORT

Mobile Banking / Financial Inclusion vs Cybersecurity Risk

Group Number	31
Option Selected	Term Paper
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Working Topic	Mobile Banking / Financial Inclusion vs Cybersecurity Risk

Purpose of this progress report

This report documents the datasets selected for the term paper, their source and properties, the volume of available responses/records, and the proposed plan for analysing the data to study the relationship between digital financial inclusion and cybersecurity risk.

1. Dataset Source and Properties

Dataset	Source	Dataset property	Web address	Amount of responses / records
Global Findex Database 2025	World Bank - Global Findex	Aggregate international database covering financial inclusion, digital payments, account use and connectivity/security indicators. Uploaded file: 8,577 rows x 438 columns.	https://www.worldbank.org/en/publication/globalfindex/download-data	Not a comments/reviews dataset. Contains 8,577 aggregate records in the uploaded file.
India Global Findex Microdata (2024 survey; 2025 database release)	World Bank - Global Findex Microdata	Individual-level India survey microdata. Uploaded file: 3,000 respondents x 199 variables. Includes survey weight, gender, age, education, income quintile, urbanicity, account ownership, digital payment variables, internet use and connectivity/security variables.	https://microdata.worldbank.org/index.php/catalog/7916	3,000 individual survey responses (primary feedback / respondent records).

Clarification on “comments/reviews/feedback”

These are survey/statistical datasets rather than review-text datasets. Therefore, the relevant feedback quantity is the number of respondent records. For the India microdata, this is 3,000

respondents. The global file is an aggregate database and contains 8,577 records in the uploaded copy.

2. What We Are Going to Do with the Dataset

- **Measure financial inclusion and mobile/digital banking adoption:** Use variables such as financial-account ownership, digital account use, any digital payment, merchant digital payments, utility payments, savings, borrowing and related indicators to understand access to and use of formal financial services.
- **Measure cybersecurity exposure and digital-safety behaviour:** Use the connectivity/security variables in the India microdata to study scam exposure, security behaviour, digital-safety concerns and related cybersecurity-risk indicators.
- **Compare important user groups:** Analyse differences across age, gender, education, income quintile, employment and urban/rural status to identify which groups are more financially included and which groups may be more exposed or vulnerable to cyber risk.
- **Study the inclusion-risk relationship:** Compare digital-finance users with non-users and test whether greater use of mobile/digital financial services is associated with higher cyber-risk exposure, while also examining whether stronger security practices are associated with lower vulnerability.
- **Use the global database for context:** Use the aggregate Global Findex database to place the India findings in a broader international/regional context and to create supporting comparison charts where appropriate.
- **Identify an entrepreneurship-oriented market gap:** Translate the evidence into a market-gap statement: whether newly included digital-finance users need simpler fraud prevention, security education, alerts, or support solutions that current mobile-banking experiences do not adequately provide.

3. Proposed Analysis Framework

Component	Example variables	Planned use
Financial inclusion / digital finance	account_fin, account, dig_account, anydigpayment, merchantpay_dig, saved, borrowed	Describe access and usage; construct digital-finance adoption indicators.
Cybersecurity / digital risk	internet_use and con* connectivity/security variables	Measure security behaviour, scam exposure, safety concerns and vulnerability-related indicators.
Demographic controls	female, age, educ, inc_q, emp_in, urbanicity	Identify vulnerable or underserved segments and control for user characteristics.
Survey design	wgt	Use survey weights for population-level estimates instead of treating the 3,000 records as a simple unweighted sample.

4. Initial Research Questions

RQ1. Does greater use of mobile/digital financial services correspond with stronger financial inclusion?

RQ2. Are users of digital financial services more exposed to scams or other digital-security risks?

RQ3. Do security practices and digital-safety awareness reduce vulnerability among mobile-banking users?

RQ4. Which demographic groups show the largest gap between digital-finance adoption and cybersecurity preparedness?

5. Current Progress and Next Steps

Completed: Term-paper topic finalized; relevant World Bank datasets identified and downloaded; uploaded files verified; India microdata selected as the primary analytical dataset.

Next: Create the final variable dictionary, clean/recode variables, generate descriptive statistics and charts, perform group comparisons/association tests, interpret findings, identify the market gap, and write the final term paper.

Important: No final claim about the relationship between financial inclusion and cybersecurity risk will be made until the statistical analysis is completed.

Primary dataset for analysis: India Global Findex microdata (3,000 respondents).